

UP24 require a smartphone with Bluetooth Low Energy. So check compatibility with the operating system and smartphone you use.

Durability. Trackers come in a variety of materials and shapes. While some are designed for pure aesthetic reasons, others may have been designed with the aim to maximise functionality. So if looks alone aren't your thing, go for a tracker that can stand the test of time. Trackers like Jawbone UP24 come with a removable cap that you could lose in a few months. Trackers with displays usually feature plastic screens that can scratch easily, while expensive models like the Apple Watch come with Ion-X or sapphire crystal faces that are extremely resistant to scratches. How rough are you with your electronics?

Water resistance. This should not have been in this list, because a fitness tracker that is being used in sweaty and moist conditions with a very good chance of getting drenched, or used while swimming, should have waterproofing by default. However, most of the trackers available have various degrees of water resistance. Some manufacturers call their devices shower-resistant but not water-proof, while others say that you can wear it in rain but not in shower!

Top fitness trackers

The following top five fitness trackers are being listed after taking the average of various reviews and guides across the web.

Best value tracker: Fitbit Charge HR. Offering the best bang for buck, the Fitbit Charge HR has outshone Jawbone UP24, which was one of the most popular wristbands in 2014. It comes with a display, heart rate tracking and an altimeter—which were missing in Jawbone UP24—while still maintaining a very minimalist design. Perfect if you are looking for

a device that offers a lot of value for your precious money.

Best designed tracker: Jawbone UP4. The latest tracker in the UP portfolio, it makes up for the lack of a display over the Charge HR by packaging itself in a very attractive design and featuring double the battery life. The Jawbone wristbands have also been known for their superior sleep tracking and better-designed smartphone apps. However, it shoots itself in the foot due to an annoying clasp that frequently gets lost and a big price tag to boot.

Best full-option tracker: Garmin Vivoactive. This device is about 50 per cent more expensive than a Fitbit Charge HR, but makes up for the extra cost by featuring built-in sports apps, movement alerts, call-, text-, email- and calendar notifications, an excellent touchscreen and in-built GPS. Garmin claims that the battery can last up to three weeks in tracking mode, or ten hours in GPS mode. It also has a rating of 5 ATM waterproofing, which means you can swim, sweat and shower with this tracker on your wrist.

Best stealth tracker: Withings Active Pop. Some people would do anything to make themselves not seem like a geek. This device is cleverly disguised as an analogue watch (with no backlight though), but comes with activity tracking, decent sleep monitoring and a whopping eight months of battery life. On the flip side, its step counter does not work properly if you don't move your arm while walking. And if you were to activate its silent alarm mode, the battery life drops to more than a third of what you were promised. Pop!

There are so many options in the market that you might be able to find something that suits you much better than our top picks. So stop procrastinating and get yourself a suitable tracker to begin your new tech-enabled fitness regime, if you have been dreaming about it. **EFY**

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